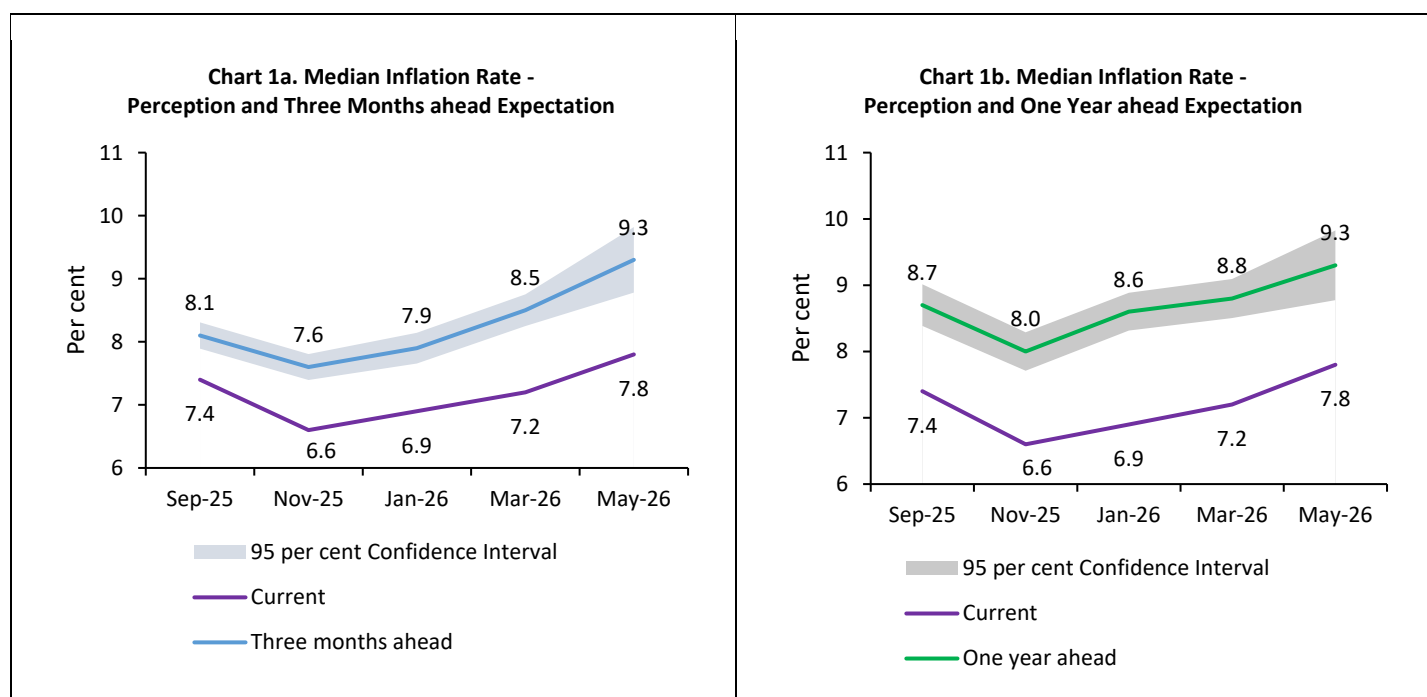


Households' Inflation Expectations Survey

Today, the Reserve Bank released the results of May 2026 round of its bi-monthly Inflation Expectations Survey of Households (IESH)^{1 2}. The survey was conducted during May 2-11, 2026, in 19 major cities, with 5,936 responses.

Highlights:

- The current median inflation perception of households increased sequentially by 60 basis points (bps) to 7.8 per cent as compared to the previous round. Their inflation expectations for the next three months and one year edged up by 80 basis points and 50 basis points, respectively, reaching 9.3 per cent for both horizons [Charts 1a and 1b; Table 3].
- At the short-term horizon, the proportion of respondents anticipating higher general prices and inflation inched up; with similar trend observed across the product groups [Table 1(a)].



Note: [Please see the excel file for time series data](#)³

¹ The survey is conducted at bi-monthly intervals by the Reserve Bank; it provides directional information on near-term inflationary pressures as expected by respondents and may reflect their own consumption patterns. Hence, survey results reflect respondents' views, which are not necessarily shared by the Reserve Bank.

² All estimates of inflation expectations are given in terms of median, unless stated otherwise.

³ Results of the previous survey round were released on the Bank's website on [April 08, 2026](#). Unit-level data for previous rounds of the survey are available on the Bank's 'Database on Indian Economy' (DBIE) portal (weblink: <https://data.rbi.org.in/DBIE/#/dbie/home>) under the head 'Unit-level Data'.

Table 1(a): Product-wise Expectations of Prices for Three Months ahead										
(Percentage of Respondents)										
Survey period ended	May-25		Nov-25		Jan-26		Mar-26		May-26	
General	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE
Prices will increase	80.5	0.86	74.6	0.90	78.6	0.91	81.6	0.90	83.5	0.78
Price increase more than current rate	54.4	1.24	50.7	1.14	54.6	1.20	57.2	1.21	60.4	1.16
Price increase similar to current rate	22.0	0.92	20.2	0.87	20.6	0.87	20.9	0.85	19.7	0.90
Price increase less than current rate	4.1	0.42	3.7	0.38	3.3	0.37	3.6	0.40	3.4	0.40
No changes in prices	17.5	0.83	21.5	0.84	18.9	0.88	16.8	0.89	14.0	0.71
Decline in prices	2.0	0.30	3.9	0.41	2.5	0.35	1.5	0.24	2.5	0.32
Food Product										
Prices will increase	82.8	0.79	74.9	0.84	80.0	0.81	83.8	0.75	85.4	0.73
Price increase more than current rate	55.8	1.11	50.5	1.04	55.7	1.11	59.4	1.16	60.7	1.13
Price increase similar to current rate	17.7	0.80	18.2	0.77	18.9	0.81	18.4	0.81	18.6	0.83
Price increase less than current rate	9.3	0.62	6.2	0.49	5.4	0.46	6.0	0.52	6.0	0.52
No changes in prices	11.9	0.66	16.1	0.72	14.5	0.71	12.4	0.68	10.4	0.61
Decline in prices	5.4	0.45	8.9	0.58	5.5	0.46	3.8	0.37	4.1	0.38
Non- Food Product										
Prices will increase	75.3	0.92	67.8	0.95	72.2	0.93	77.6	0.90	81.1	0.78
Price increase more than current rate	51.5	1.14	44.3	1.08	48.8	1.16	54.0	1.15	56.8	1.16
Price increase similar to current rate	17.5	0.75	17.6	0.76	18.3	0.82	18.1	0.77	18.7	0.83
Price increase less than current rate	6.2	0.50	5.9	0.46	5.1	0.43	5.5	0.45	5.6	0.49
No changes in prices	20.2	0.83	24.7	0.87	22.7	0.87	19.0	0.86	14.6	0.69
Decline in prices	4.6	0.40	7.5	0.54	5.2	0.46	3.4	0.34	4.3	0.40
Household Durables										
Prices will increase	66.3	1.01	53.2	1.02	61.3	1.05	65.4	1.00	68.2	0.97
Price increase more than current rate	45.5	1.12	36.1	1.03	42.4	1.10	44.7	1.11	46.8	1.14
Price increase similar to current rate	15.3	0.69	13.4	0.70	15.1	0.74	15.9	0.69	16.9	0.79
Price increase less than current rate	5.5	0.46	3.8	0.38	3.9	0.36	4.9	0.44	4.5	0.42
No changes in prices	26.6	0.94	29.4	0.91	28.2	0.99	25.6	0.91	24.3	0.87
Decline in prices	7.1	0.50	17.4	0.75	10.4	0.59	9.0	0.56	7.5	0.51
Cost of Housing										
Prices will increase	78.3	0.93	77.4	0.86	78.5	0.86	78.4	0.90	78.3	0.87
Price increase more than current rate	57.1	1.16	54.8	1.12	57.8	1.10	57.8	1.14	56.3	1.13
Price increase similar to current rate	16.7	0.75	17.9	0.78	17.5	0.76	17.0	0.73	18.0	0.83
Price increase less than current rate	4.4	0.41	4.7	0.40	3.2	0.34	3.6	0.37	4.0	0.42
No changes in prices	19.1	0.88	18.5	0.81	17.9	0.81	19.1	0.88	18.4	0.80
Decline in prices	2.6	0.31	4.1	0.39	3.5	0.36	2.5	0.30	3.3	0.36
Cost of Services										
Prices will increase	69.9	0.97	63.8	0.97	68.4	0.96	69.8	1.01	71.1	0.92
Price increase more than current rate	49.7	1.13	43.3	1.11	47.3	1.14	48.7	1.14	49.1	1.16
Price increase similar to current rate	15.9	0.73	16.1	0.73	17.5	0.79	17.2	0.72	17.4	0.80
Price increase less than current rate	4.3	0.41	4.4	0.42	3.6	0.38	3.9	0.37	4.5	0.47
No changes in prices	28.0	0.97	32.5	0.95	28.3	0.96	27.9	0.98	25.5	0.88
Decline in prices	2.1	0.27	3.7	0.39	3.2	0.37	2.3	0.28	3.4	0.38
Note:										
1. The table provides estimates and standard errors (SE) for qualitative responses.										
2. Constituent items may not add up to the corresponding total, due to rounding off.										

Table 1(b): Product-wise Expectations of Prices for One Year ahead										
(Percentage of Respondents)										
Survey period ended	May-25		Nov-25		Jan-26		Mar-26		May-26	
General	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE
Prices will increase	89.2	0.68	83.6	0.75	88.8	0.69	90.0	0.66	86.9	0.76
Price increase more than current rate	64.7	1.18	60.0	1.17	63.6	1.13	67.5	1.19	63.6	1.23
Price increase similar to current rate	21.5	0.97	20.6	0.88	22.9	0.93	19.6	0.88	19.7	0.90
Price increase less than current rate	3.0	0.38	3.1	0.34	2.3	0.30	2.8	0.35	3.6	0.41
No changes in prices	8.8	0.61	13.0	0.65	8.5	0.60	8.3	0.61	10.1	0.65
Decline in prices	2.0	0.26	3.4	0.41	2.6	0.34	1.7	0.27	3.0	0.38
Food Product										
Prices will increase	87.0	0.66	81.8	0.80	85.5	0.75	87.4	0.68	85.9	0.73
Price increase more than current rate	59.2	1.10	54.0	1.14	58.9	1.17	61.1	1.19	59.0	1.23
Price increase similar to current rate	20.3	0.86	22.9	0.86	22.2	0.90	21.5	0.88	22.2	0.94
Price increase less than current rate	7.5	0.57	4.9	0.44	4.5	0.42	4.8	0.45	4.7	0.48
No changes in prices	10.0	0.58	12.8	0.66	10.1	0.63	9.3	0.60	9.6	0.59
Decline in prices	3.0	0.32	5.4	0.47	4.4	0.43	3.2	0.36	4.4	0.42
Non- Food Product										
Prices will increase	81.9	0.78	78.1	0.82	80.5	0.83	83.7	0.79	82.7	0.81
Price increase more than current rate	55.8	1.12	52.7	1.11	56.5	1.17	58.6	1.18	56.7	1.24
Price increase similar to current rate	20.7	0.80	20.1	0.80	19.9	0.83	21.2	0.85	21.6	0.94
Price increase less than current rate	5.4	0.46	5.2	0.45	4.2	0.40	3.9	0.40	4.5	0.44
No changes in prices	15.2	0.73	16.6	0.72	15.4	0.75	13.4	0.73	13.1	0.67
Decline in prices	2.9	0.32	5.3	0.48	4.1	0.41	2.9	0.33	4.1	0.44
Household Durables										
Prices will increase	77.0	0.89	68.0	0.95	72.9	0.91	75.3	0.92	75.0	0.92
Price increase more than current rate	54.8	1.12	46.1	1.12	51.4	1.14	52.6	1.19	51.5	1.22
Price increase similar to current rate	17.8	0.79	17.4	0.77	17.8	0.80	18.6	0.79	19.6	0.88
Price increase less than current rate	4.4	0.40	4.5	0.44	3.7	0.37	4.1	0.42	3.8	0.39
No changes in prices	17.9	0.81	21.1	0.80	19.3	0.84	18.7	0.80	18.7	0.81
Decline in prices	5.1	0.41	11.0	0.65	7.8	0.53	6.0	0.45	6.3	0.48
Cost of Housing										
Prices will increase	88.2	0.69	87.9	0.67	88.0	0.65	89.4	0.60	87.0	0.73
Price increase more than current rate	65.9	1.06	64.9	1.08	66.9	1.06	67.0	1.08	64.3	1.12
Price increase similar to current rate	18.5	0.82	19.2	0.86	18.4	0.83	18.5	0.80	19.0	0.83
Price increase less than current rate	3.8	0.40	3.8	0.37	2.8	0.31	3.9	0.41	3.7	0.41
No changes in prices	9.7	0.63	8.6	0.56	8.8	0.56	8.9	0.56	10.1	0.60
Decline in prices	2.1	0.27	3.5	0.40	3.2	0.37	1.7	0.25	2.9	0.38
Cost of Services										
Prices will increase	83.0	0.77	79.0	0.85	81.9	0.80	82.6	0.78	81.3	0.87
Price increase more than current rate	59.9	1.12	55.1	1.16	57.2	1.16	57.2	1.15	56.4	1.21
Price increase similar to current rate	18.2	0.77	19.2	0.83	20.5	0.85	20.8	0.83	20.6	0.92
Price increase less than current rate	4.8	0.44	4.7	0.45	4.1	0.39	4.6	0.43	4.3	0.41
No changes in prices	15.0	0.75	17.6	0.77	15.2	0.75	15.4	0.75	15.3	0.77
Decline in prices	2.0	0.26	3.4	0.41	2.9	0.36	2.1	0.27	3.4	0.42
Note:										
1. The table provides estimates and standard errors (SE) for qualitative responses.										
2. Constituent items may not add up to the corresponding total, due to rounding off.										

Table 2: Inflation Expectations of Various Groups: May-26

	Current Perception				Three Months ahead Expectation				One Year ahead Expectation			
	Mean		Median		Mean		Median		Mean		Median	
	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE
Overall	8.5	0.09	7.8	0.13	9.7	0.09	9.3	0.27	9.2	0.11	9.3	0.27
Gender-wise												
Male	8.6	0.13	7.8	0.21	9.8	0.13	9.5	0.36	9.2	0.16	9.2	0.42
Female	8.6	0.12	8.0	0.17	9.8	0.12	9.7	0.31	9.2	0.16	9.5	0.32
Category-wise												
Financial Sector Employees	8.8	0.46	8.0	0.63	9.5	0.46	8.7	0.43	8.9	0.53	8.7	0.48
Other Employees	8.4	0.16	7.6	0.25	9.7	0.19	9.1	0.39	9.3	0.22	9.3	0.48
Self Employed	9.1	0.20	8.6	0.48	10.3	0.21	10.2	0.15	9.5	0.26	9.9	0.40
Homemaker	8.5	0.15	7.9	0.21	9.8	0.15	9.4	0.38	9.1	0.19	9.3	0.35
Retired Persons	9.0	0.35	7.8	0.78	10.3	0.36	10.0	0.51	9.4	0.48	9.2	0.82
Daily Workers	8.7	0.29	8.2	0.43	9.6	0.28	9.2	0.57	9.2	0.35	10.0	0.44
Other category	8.2	0.20	7.3	0.24	9.4	0.22	8.6	0.38	9.1	0.26	9.2	0.50
Age Group-wise												
Up to 25 years	7.8	0.19	7.1	0.24	9.1	0.20	8.4	0.30	9.0	0.23	8.9	0.41
25 to 30 years	8.4	0.18	7.6	0.26	9.4	0.19	8.7	0.25	9.2	0.23	9.4	0.42
30 to 35 years	8.5	0.19	7.9	0.29	9.9	0.20	9.8	0.35	8.9	0.26	9.2	0.55
35 to 40 years	8.8	0.20	8.3	0.24	9.9	0.20	9.9	0.37	9.3	0.25	9.5	0.48
40 to 45 years	8.9	0.22	8.3	0.26	9.8	0.23	9.4	0.47	9.4	0.29	9.7	0.44
45 to 50 years	9.1	0.24	8.3	0.51	10.0	0.25	9.5	0.54	9.3	0.32	9.4	0.62
50 to 55 years	8.8	0.26	7.8	0.40	9.8	0.27	9.4	0.59	9.0	0.36	8.8	0.69
55 to 60 years	8.8	0.29	8.2	0.69	10.2	0.31	9.9	0.52	9.1	0.38	9.2	0.80
60 years and above	9.0	0.27	8.2	0.52	10.3	0.26	10.3	0.17	9.4	0.36	9.7	0.59
City-wise												
Ahmedabad	6.7	0.24	6.0	0.14	7.7	0.33	6.9	0.27	7.2	0.35	6.8	0.36
Bengaluru	5.9	0.15	5.4	0.08	7.8	0.17	7.3	0.23	7.9	0.22	7.6	0.26
Bhopal	8.5	0.74	7.6	1.24	9.7	0.56	9.3	0.99	9.3	0.58	8.9	1.13
Bhubaneswar	7.6	0.59	6.4	0.65	9.0	0.49	8.1	0.56	8.9	0.61	8.7	0.55
Chennai	7.9	0.40	7.1	0.69	9.2	0.34	9.0	0.69	9.2	0.35	9.9	0.55
Delhi	9.8	0.26	9.9	0.41	11.1	0.25	10.8	0.39	9.7	0.29	10.2	0.38
Guwahati	7.6	0.59	6.9	0.81	7.7	0.57	6.6	0.93	8.1	1.05	7.8	1.31
Hyderabad	7.9	0.24	7.4	0.39	9.2	0.27	8.9	0.45	8.5	0.40	9.1	0.59
Jaipur	7.9	0.43	7.7	0.40	8.5	0.41	8.3	0.50	7.7	0.61	8.0	0.68
Jammu	9.0	0.91	9.2	1.22	8.9	0.57	8.6	1.27	8.9	0.91	8.6	1.28
Kolkata	10.2	0.32	10.2	0.17	10.9	0.30	10.6	0.21	9.5	0.40	9.9	0.63
Lucknow	9.2	0.47	8.8	0.75	10.1	0.60	9.7	0.82	9.7	0.55	9.4	0.84
Mumbai	9.7	0.21	9.1	0.41	11.2	0.23	10.6	0.14	10.8	0.32	10.9	0.33
Nagpur	8.8	0.40	8.7	0.35	10.1	0.43	10.1	0.48	9.8	0.86	10.8	0.76
Patna	7.1	0.55	6.1	0.44	7.4	0.54	6.5	0.47	7.1	0.60	6.8	0.55
Thiruvananthapuram	7.2	0.65	5.6	0.33	8.8	0.69	8.0	0.80	9.9	0.85	9.3	1.19
Chandigarh	7.9	0.63	7.2	1.00	8.4	0.66	7.7	1.41	8.4	0.65	7.7	1.17
Ranchi	8.3	0.35	7.3	0.31	8.7	0.37	7.9	0.35	8.9	0.61	8.8	0.36
Raipur	7.3	0.54	6.6	0.65	7.9	0.56	7.1	0.53	8.0	1.02	7.6	1.00

Note: The table provides estimates and standard errors (SE) for quantitative responses.

Table 3: Household Inflation Expectations – Current Perception, Three Months and One Year Ahead Expectations												
	Current Perception				Three Months ahead Expectation				One Year ahead Expectation			
	Mean		Median		Mean		Median		Mean		Median	
	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE	Estimate	SE
May-25	8.4	0.08	7.7	0.12	9.5	0.09	8.9	0.12	9.4	0.11	9.5	0.25
Jul-25	8.1	0.12	7.2	0.26	8.9	0.13	8.3	0.26	8.7	0.17	9.0	0.39
Sep-25	8.4	0.08	7.4	0.13	9.0	0.08	8.1	0.11	8.8	0.11	8.7	0.16
Nov-25	7.7	0.08	6.6	0.14	8.4	0.08	7.6	0.10	8.1	0.10	8.0	0.15
Jan-26	7.8	0.08	6.9	0.16	8.9	0.09	7.9	0.12	8.9	0.11	8.6	0.15
Mar-26	8.2	0.09	7.2	0.13	9.3	0.09	8.5	0.13	9.1	0.11	8.8	0.15
May-26	8.5	0.09	7.8	0.13	9.7	0.09	9.3	0.27	9.2	0.11	9.3	0.27
Note: The table provides estimates and standard errors (SE) for quantitative responses.												

Table 4: Households Expecting General Price Movements in Coherence with Movements in Price Expectations of Various Product Groups: Three Months Ahead and One Year Ahead					
(Percentage of Respondents)					
Survey period ended	Food	Non-Food	Household durables	Housing	Cost of services
Three Months Ahead					
May-25	63.5	64.8	60.4	63.6	67.4
Jul-25	65.9	70.5	48.7	50.9	62.7
Sep-25	59.6	63.8	65.3	64.3	71.8
Nov-25	62.4	62.6	55.1	62.1	65.4
Jan-26	65.9	66.6	60.0	64.8	68.6
Mar-26	65.5	66.5	59.0	64.6	66.4
May-26	66.6	67.4	59.4	63.9	66.6
One Year Ahead					
May-25	74.4	70.5	68.6	72.7	75.4
Jul-25	81.6	78.1	69.5	61.9	61.8
Sep-25	75.5	67.8	71.4	69.7	73.0
Nov-25	83.4	70.3	61.7	71.0	71.1
Jan-26	71.7	71.0	64.5	73.0	72.8
Mar-26	73.6	73.8	68.0	74.7	74.2
May-26	74.3	72.7	67.4	74.1	73.8

Table 5(a): Cross-tabulation of Number of Respondents by Current Inflation Perception and Three Months Ahead Inflation Expectations: May-26																				
Current Inflation Rate (per cent)	Three Months Ahead Inflation Rate (per cent)																			
		<1	1-<2	2-<3	3-<4	4-<5	5-<6	6-<7	7-<8	8-<9	9-<10	10-<11	11-<12	12-<13	13-<14	14-<15	15-<16	>=16	No idea	Total
	<1	7	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	8
	1-<2	2	23	27	11	3	1	0	0	0	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	69
	2-<3	0	8	94	83	38	11	5	1	0	0	8	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	248
	3-<4	0	9	6	90	70	80	11	3	2	0	11	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	282
	4-<5	0	3	5	9	128	92	56	16	15	1	10	0	0	1	5	5	46	1	393
	5-<6	1	1	13	24	19	437	215	206	102	13	142	1	1	0	0	7	124	2	1308
	6-<7	0	1	0	5	9	8	138	103	69	20	24	2	4	0	0	1	0	0	384
	7-<8	0	0	2	1	4	7	3	173	94	59	76	4	7	0	1	0	2	0	433
	8-<9	0	0	2	2	3	7	6	3	152	65	152	8	25	4	3	4	4	0	440
	9-<10	0	0	0	2	0	0	1	1	1	53	48	9	31	6	4	5	1	0	162
	10-<11	0	0	4	4	2	81	2	9	18	4	412	79	213	54	22	183	121	1	1209
	11-<12	0	0	0	0	0	2	0	1	1	0	1	11	5	1	0	2	2	0	26
	12-<13	0	0	0	0	0	4	1	0	0	0	4	0	29	8	5	29	8	0	88
	13-<14	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	0	0	5	3	4	1	0	15
	14-<15	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	3	3	6	0	12
	15-<16	0	0	0	0	0	24	0	0	0	0	6	0	4	1	1	67	80	0	183
	>=16	3	0	2	0	1	83	0	0	0	0	24	0	0	1	0	19	540	3	676
	Total	13	46	155	231	277	837	438	516	454	215	922	114	319	81	47	329	935	7	5936

Table 5(b): Cross-tabulation of Number of Respondents by Current Inflation Perception and One Year Ahead Inflation Expectations: May-26																				
Current Inflation Rate (per cent)	One Year Ahead Inflation Rate (per cent)																			
		<1	1-<2	2-<3	3-<4	4-<5	5-<6	6-<7	7-<8	8-<9	9-<10	10-<11	11-<12	12-<13	13-<14	14-<15	15-<16	>=16	No idea	Total
	<1	7	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	8
	1-<2	13	9	23	13	6	1	0	1	0	1	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	69
	2-<3	28	5	49	71	59	28	3	1	0	1	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	248
	3-<4	37	2	4	49	55	88	25	4	2	1	12	2	1	0	0	0	0	0	282
	4-<5	47	1	6	10	71	74	75	23	19	3	4	1	3	1	0	7	47	1	393
	5-<6	133	1	8	16	18	261	174	219	125	27	184	3	12	0	0	6	119	2	1308
	6-<7	36	1	2	2	7	3	88	76	75	28	48	2	12	1	1	2	0	0	384
	7-<8	40	0	0	0	1	6	0	96	56	73	113	9	26	3	2	5	3	0	433
	8-<9	51	0	0	0	2	4	1	3	77	49	142	12	68	7	5	16	3	0	440
	9-<10	15	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	1	26	35	13	28	5	7	30	1	0	162
	10-<11	173	0	1	3	1	22	3	1	12	5	288	41	150	43	26	298	142	0	1209
	11-<12	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	6	3	4	4	2	1	0	26
	12-<13	17	0	0	0	0	2	1	0	0	0	0	0	10	7	10	27	14	0	88
	13-<14	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	5	2	5	3	0	15
	14-<15	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	4	2	6	0	12
	15-<16	23	0	0	0	0	9	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	61	89	0	183
	>=16	134	0	2	2	1	35	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	501	0	676
	Total	759	20	95	166	221	534	370	424	370	214	831	89	313	76	61	461	929	3	5936